

DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY

would resonate with most of us after two full years of living in isolation, with our worlds turned still. "Not being able to travel during the pandemic was extremely difficult on me," he says. "I felt deprived of something essential in my life. We knew it was a risk to take a holiday with the pandemic still going on, but we decided to take it. If I had let Covid hold me back, I would have missed out on one of the most eye-opening, beautiful experiences of my life." Time had, literally, given access to space in his case.

Others are finding different ways to fulfil their dreams before time runs out. Sunita Ahuja, 65, decided to start studying again—after a gap of over 45 years. "I had wanted to do a course in English literature ever since I was a child," says the Delhi-based homemaker. "But after marriage, I never had the chance. I kept saying to myself that 'I would do it the next year'...and the procrastination never stopped. After I turned 50, I was too afraid that I won't be able to study again." Then, Covid struck, and she realised, it was now or never. "After losing a close friend to Covid," she says, "I woke up one morning and thought, 'What if I die tomorrow and never



BANDEEP SINGH

DIPINDER SINGH, *56*

Fashion designer and clothier, ***Delhi***

Dreams fulfilled

Started to cook and set up a home gym

How Covid changed me

"The pandemic stirred in me a culinary awakening. It also made me realise that I needed to focus on myself, because if I don't, no one elase will"